

H2 / PAID FIELD GUIDE

AI BUSINESS OPERATIONS PACK.

Six repeatable systems, prompts and templates for turning useful AI experiments into calmer day-to-day operations.

For founders, operators and small teams. Built to be used on live work - not admired as theory.

START HERE

MAKE AI USEFUL - WITHOUT TURNING YOUR BUSINESS INTO A TOOL EXPERIMENT.

This pack is for work that repeats: incoming leads, discovery and onboarding, meeting follow-up, SOPs, support patterns and the short weekly review that keeps the useful improvements alive.

Use one system at a time. Put a human check wherever an output could affect a customer, a payment, a contract or a public claim.

The operating rule

A workflow is useful only when it has a named owner, a clear input, a visible definition of a good output and a way to check whether it saved time without lowering quality.

Inside

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| 01 | Workflow map
Choose work that is worth improving before you automate it. |
| 02 | Lead qualification
Turn uneven enquiries into a reviewable next-action brief. |
| 03 | Client onboarding
Create a clear project start without inventing scope or commitments. |
| 04 | Meeting to action
Make notes useful while the context is still fresh. |
| 05 | SOP builder
Capture repeatable work so it does not live in one person's head. |
| 06 | Weekly operations review
Keep the patterns that work and stop the ones that do not. |

CHOOSE THE RIGHT TASK FIRST

Start with a task that happens at least weekly, has recognisable inputs and produces a result someone can judge. Do not begin with a process that is changing every day or one where no one owns the final decision.

Copy-ready prompt

For this task, define: (1) the trigger, (2) the exact inputs, (3) the useful output, (4) the person who reviews it, (5) the current time spent each month, and (6) the risk if the output is wrong. Return a compact workflow map. Do not invent missing facts.

Implementation check

Before using the output: compare it with the original input, confirm any customer-facing claims, and keep a named owner for the final decision.

MAKE THE FIRST PASS FASTER, NOT AUTOMATIC

AI can reduce the friction of reading a mixed-quality enquiry. It should extract and organise; a person should decide priority, price, promises and the reply that goes out under your name.

Copy-ready prompt

Read this customer enquiry. Create: (1) likely goal, (2) confirmed requirements, (3) missing information, (4) urgency signals, (5) a suggested next action, and (6) a short response draft. Do not invent prices, deadlines, capabilities or commitments. Label uncertainty clearly.

Implementation check

Before using the output: compare it with the original input, confirm any customer-facing claims, and keep a named owner for the final decision.

CREATE A VISIBLE PROJECT START

A good onboarding pack separates what is agreed from what is assumed. Use the proposal, discovery notes and client messages as source material; preserve the original records beside the summary.

Copy-ready prompt

Using the supplied proposal, discovery notes and emails, create an internal onboarding brief with: confirmed goals, agreed deliverables, explicit dates, responsibilities, required access, source links and unanswered questions. Do not infer scope, pricing, approvals or dates. Mark every uncertainty.

Implementation check

Before using the output: compare it with the original input, confirm any customer-facing claims, and keep a named owner for the final decision.

TURN CONVERSATIONS INTO OWNED NEXT MOVES

Meeting summaries fail when they are merely shorter transcripts. The useful result is a small list of decisions, actions, owners and deadlines that participants can correct quickly.

Copy-ready prompt

Turn these meeting notes into: (1) decisions made, (2) action items with owner and due date only where explicitly stated, (3) open questions, (4) risks or dependencies, and (5) a concise follow-up email. Do not assign ownership, dates or commitments that were not stated.

Implementation check

Before using the output: compare it with the original input, confirm any customer-facing claims, and keep a named owner for the final decision.

DOCUMENT THE VERSION THAT SURVIVED REAL WORK

Do not write an SOP for an imaginary perfect process. Observe a process after several real runs, then make its inputs, decisions, hand-offs and quality checks visible.

Copy-ready prompt

Draft a practical SOP from this process description. Include: purpose, trigger, inputs, step-by-step actions, decision points, exceptions, final quality check, owner and links to source materials. Flag missing details as questions instead of filling gaps.

Implementation check

Before using the output: compare it with the original input, confirm any customer-facing claims, and keep a named owner for the final decision.

IMPROVE ONE THING AND STOP THE NOISE

A weekly review turns isolated experiments into an operating loop. Keep it short: look at one workflow, compare with the old way of working and decide the next smallest change.

Copy-ready prompt

Review this week's workflow evidence. Return: (1) what saved time or improved quality, (2) what introduced risk or friction, (3) one change to test next week, (4) what to stop doing, and (5) the single metric to record. Be specific and avoid generic recommendations.

Implementation check

Before using the output: compare it with the original input, confirm any customer-facing claims, and keep a named owner for the final decision.

TEMPLATES

SIX SMALL TEMPLATES FOR REAL WORK.

Workflow baseline

Task | Trigger | Input | Useful output | Owner | Human check | Monthly time | Quality signal

Lead review

Source | Goal | Fit | Missing information | Priority | Next action | Draft reply | Reviewer

Onboarding brief

Client | Goals | Deliverables | Dates | Access needed | People | Risks | Open questions

Action register

Action | Owner | Due date | Dependency | Status | Source / context

SOP checklist

Purpose | Trigger | Steps | Decision points | Exceptions | Quality check | Owner | Last reviewed

Weekly review

Workflow | Evidence | Time saved | Quality change | Friction | Next test | Metric | Owner

30-MINUTE IMPLEMENTATION

PICK ONE TASK. MAKE ONE CHANGE. MEASURE THE RESULT.

Minutes 0-5: choose the repeated task and write its baseline. Minutes 5-15: run the relevant prompt on a real, bounded example. Minutes 15-25: compare the AI-assisted output with the old version. Minutes 25-30: keep one improvement, name the owner and choose the metric for next week.

Do not build an automation merely because a tool can connect two systems. Build only when the payoff is meaningful and someone owns maintenance.

HACKS2 / APPLIED AI

Useful systems over noisy tool stacks.